

hold—from 1024 to 32768; an increase in the number of unique colours allowed in a spreadsheet—from 56 to 4.3 billion; etc. The entire list of enhancements can be found at <http://blogs.msdn.com/excel/archive/2005/09/26/474258.aspx> (<http://tinyurl.com/b6xd7>).

The new UI would give an impression of a development bias towards presentation and appearance aspects in Office 2007. And this impression is further fortified by the inclusion a few new visually exciting features. Newly introduced in this version is the concept of themes, which allows a set of formatting options to be saved and/or applied as a unit. The same theme can be applied across Office applications—Word, Excel, and PowerPoint—making it possible to easily create similar-looking documents. Also, now, there are more options to spruce up a spreadsheet with images, diagrams, graphs and charts, and Word Art. Graphical components and charts in a spreadsheet can now be rendered in many more styles and colour combinations, and have greater customisation options. The new charting engine in Office 2007 is responsible for all the snazzy graphics.



Many graphics options to use

While the above-mentioned examples of an emphasis on visual appeal—better looking charts and colour coded documents—would seem irrelevant to some Excel users, Excel now has the ability to use cell properties, and not just cell contents, as parameters for data manipulation. For example, if after Conditional Formatting, one has a range of cells with different colours, it is now possible to sort the range on the cell colours, so that all cells with the same colour are grouped. Combined, these two capabilities make Excel an even better tool for interpreting large amounts of data. CF is discussed in detail in the Chapter 2.